BRAND & PRODUCT
GUIDELINES

# The Equal Lens

## Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.

A clearer lens on fairness - now a living product. This edition adds everything we decided building the site: the canvas, the mascots-as-tools, a dual-audience system, and a dark mode.

Version 2.0 June 2026 theequallens.com

# From a brand to a product.

v1 set the foundation - the eQ idea, the two values, voice, colour, type, logo. v2 keeps all of it and documents the decisions we made turning it into a real, interactive website.

### The site is a canvas

Myths hide in the page as doodles & sticky notes. The mascots became cursor tools that erase them and write the truth. → p.08

### Two audiences, one brand

A Kids mode and an Adult mode, chosen on arrival and switchable any time. → p.10

### A dark theme

Adult mode runs dark. Same brand, flipped surfaces, lightened violet. → p.05

### A playful UI kit

Sticker outlines, a doodle set, hand-lettered headlines, and tasteful motion. → p.06, 09

### Two new accents

Sun yellow for highlights & CTAs, Sky blue for support - alongside teal & coral. → p.04

### Brand in code

Every colour and font ships as a named CSS token, so design and build never drift. → p.12

# See through the eQ lens.

Our mark reads as **eQ** - and that double meaning is the whole idea. **eQuality** meets **EQ**, emotional intelligence. One way of seeing the world: fairly, and with empathy. Everything in this book ladders up to it.

### VISION

**A generation that treats fairness as something they *do* - noticing bias and choosing better, on their own.**

### MISSION

**We help people unlearn bias and relearn empathy through play - before inherited ideas harden into lifelong assumptions.**

### POSITIONING

For the schools, families, workplaces, and communities raising and shaping each other, The Equal Lens makes bias visible through games and play - because what we absorb early, and repeat unthinkingly, doesn't have to be permanent.

Note: in v2 the mission widened from "children" to "people". Kids remain the heart of the work; the Adult mode (p.10) extends the same idea to grown-ups.

# Unlearn & Relearn

Two moves sit at the heart of everything - and our mascots **are** those moves. They aren't decoration; they're the value system. On the site they literally become the tools you pick up (p.08).

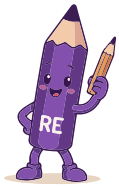



## Unlearn

UN · the eraser

Aware · Curious · Brave

Question and let go of inherited bias. Start fresh. On the page, UN erases the myth.




## Relearn

RE · the pencil

Empathy · Creative · Hopeful

Rebuild with empathy and imagination. Draw something fairer. On the page, RE writes the truth.

**Unlearn → Relearn → Grow → repeat**

A continuous loop, not a one-time fix. Awareness, empathy, critical thinking and inclusion all live inside these two.

# Curious. Warm. Brave.

**Playful, not preachy**
Invite a smile before a lesson.

**Curious, not corrective**
Ask more than we tell.

**Warm, for everyone**
Challenge the idea, never the person.

**Hopeful & active**
Learned, so it can be unlearned.

## NEW IN V2 - TWO REGISTERS, ONE VOICE

| REGISTER | STAYS | SHIFTS TO | A LINE SOUNDS LIKE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kids** | Curious, warm, brave | Short, vivid, encouraging | "Some things feel normal - but are they fair?" |
| **Adult** | Curious, warm, brave | Wry, knowing, a little deadpan - still kind | "Bias doesn't retire when you grow up." |

Adult copy can be drier and more self-aware, but never cynical, crude, or shaming. **Guardrail:** keep it PG - a kid landing on the adult site should be totally fine.

## WRITING STYLE

Do

Sentence case · hyphens, not em dashes · active voice · leave agency ("what would you do?") · vary myths, never repeat a line on a page

Avoid

SHOUTING CAPS · should / must / wrong · "the right answer" · jargon · "biasness" and other site-isms · em dashes ( - ) in copy

# A violet system, four playful accents.

## Equal Violet

#553286 · primary / brand



| 50 | 100 | 200 | 400 | 600 | 700 | 800 | 900 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| F3F0F6 | E5E0ED | C5B6DE | 7F65A4 | 553286 | 44288B | 331E50 | 221436 |

Insight Teal · #2DD4BF
Unlearn accent

Grow Coral · #FF7A5C
Relearn accent

Sun · #FFC94D
Highlight & CTA **(new)**

Sky · #4FB0E8
Support **(new)**

Paper · #FBF9FF · page bg

Surface · #FFFFFF · cards

Mist · #E7E0F1 · lines / hover

Violet leads, neutrals carry, accents appear in small doses. **Sun** is our call-to-action yellow (always with Deep Indigo text on it); teal marks "unlearn" moments, coral marks "relearn". Ink / Deep Indigo #221436 for body text and every sticker outline.

# Same brand, after dark.

Adult mode runs on a dark theme. We don't restyle the brand - we just flip a handful of tokens. Surfaces go deep indigo, text goes light, and Equal Violet *lightens* so it stays legible on dark. The accents (teal, coral, sun, sky) are unchanged.

Paper · #15101F
page bg

Surface · #221A30
cards

Mist · #3A2E4D
lines / hover

Band · #241B38
footer / CTA

Ink · #F1ECFA · text

Brand · #C9B8E6 · lightened violet

Brand-soft · #B3A4D6 · muted violet

### RULES OF THE DARK

Sticky notes stay pastel in both themes (with fixed dark text) so the "paper" metaphor survives · the Sun CTA keeps Deep Indigo text · switching themes cross-fades over 320ms · the toggle and the welcome modal are the only ways in or out.

# Playful, with purpose.

## Baloo 2

Headlines & mascots · 600 / 700 / 800

How do you identify today?

## Poppins

Wordmark & UI labels · 500 / 600

**The Equal Lens · Programs · About**

## Nunito Sans

Body · 400 / 600 / 700

Some things feel completely normal - but are they actually fair? The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog.

Evolved in v2

In v1 Baloo 2 was reserved for kids only. In the built product it carries the **playful headline voice across the whole brand** - kid and adult alike (it's the `font-hand` token). Poppins steps back to the wordmark and small UI labels; Nunito Sans still does all the reading. All three are free on Google Fonts.

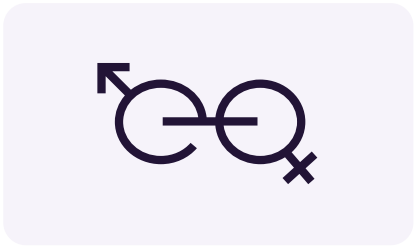
# The eQ mark



Primary · violet on light (Kids)



Reversed · white on dark (Adult)



Mono · single colour

Clear space & minimum size



Keep clear space ≥ the height of the mark's opening. Never below 24px / 8mm tall. In product the app icon uses the square avatar export.

Don't



× recolour



× stretch



× rotate



× add effects

Exports live in /brand/logo/: primary, reversed, mono, and two square avatars (violet & light) for app icon and social.

# The whole site is a canvas.

Our signature interaction. Bias hides in the page as struck-through "myths" - in doodles, scattered text, and sticky notes. Visitors pick up a mascot and act on it. The values aren't explained; they're *played*.

### Browse

The default cursor. Read, click, explore. Press Esc to drop any tool.

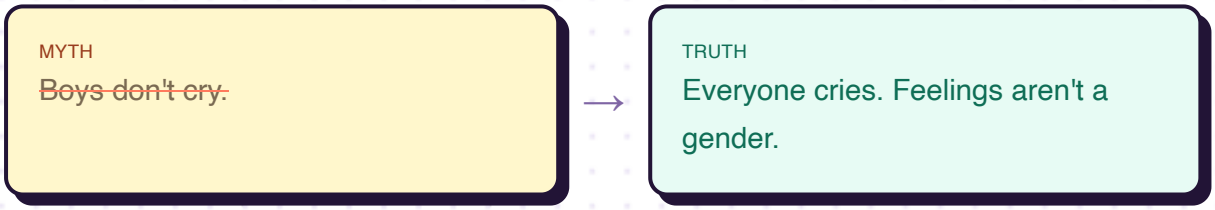
### Unlearn · UN

The eraser. Rub out a myth - the struck text and the sticky note disappear.

### Relearn · RE

The pencil. Reveals the truth on a note, or free-draws on the page.

## HOW A MYTH IS BUILT




Each myth is structured content (myth · truth · explanation · sources · category · audience) in an OKF-aligned knowledge base. Content drives the interaction - add a myth file and it appears on the page.

**Accessibility:** the canvas is an enhancement, never a gate. Touch, keyboard, and reduced-motion all get a plain fallback; on small screens myths become tappable cards above the footer.

# The playful kit.

Sticker surface

Sticker

CTA

Chunky outline (2.5px Ink) + a hard offset shadow (4px 4px, no blur). Cards, buttons, notes - all share this cut-out look. The outline uses the Ink token, so it flips with the theme.

Doodle set



Eight hand-drawn marks - squiggle, sparkle, arrow, heart, star, spiral, zigzag, swirl - in accent colours. Used sparingly as easter-egg texture, never as functional icons.

Motion - lively but tasteful

| TOKEN | MOTION | USED ON |
|---|---|---|
| anim-float | gentle 9px rise & fall, 5s | doodles, hero art |
| anim-wobble | ±4° rock, 4.5s | stars, badges |
| anim-bob | bob + tilt, 5.5s | mascots |
| anim-pop | spring scale-in, 0.5s | notes appearing |
| hover-pop | lift + 1.5° tilt on hover | cards, buttons |

Theme changes cross-fade over 320ms. Everything here is disabled under prefers-reduced-motion - motion is seasoning, never load-bearing.

# Kids & grown-ups, same lens.

Bias doesn't retire when you grow up. So the site runs in two modes - chosen on arrival with a quirky "How do you identify today?" modal, and switchable any time from the header toggle. The choice is remembered.

### Kids mode

light theme · default

Bright, playful, doodle-heavy. Topics: feelings, fairness, who-can-do-what, bodies & consent (age-appropriate), inclusion. The encouraging register.

### Adult mode

dark theme

Wry, knowing, dark. Topics: work & money, relationships & home (raising kids, parental leave), single dads adopting, stigma around women ageing or unmarried, body image & media, leadership & confidence.

**THE ONE GUARDRAIL**

Adult content stays **PG**. It can be candid and dryly funny, but a child who wanders into Adult mode should see nothing harmful - just grown-up situations. Every adult myth is written to that bar.

Mechanically: an audience cookie drives everything - copy, myths, theme, even the logo. No choice yet = the welcome modal; Esc or "decide later" quietly defaults to Kids so we never nag.

# How we say it.

| ROLE | LINE | USE FOR |
|---|---|---|
| Signature | Unlearn. Relearn. Grow. | Lockup, sign-offs, merch |
| Hook | Bias is learned - so it can be unlearned. | Headlines, ads, pitch openers |
| Concept | See fairness through the eQ lens. | About page, decks |
| Adult hook | Bias doesn't retire when you grow up. | Adult-mode hero, campaigns |

### BOILERPLATE · 25 WORDS

The Equal Lens helps people unlearn bias and relearn empathy through play - turning fairness into something we notice, question, and create, not something we're lectured about.

### BOILERPLATE · 100 WORDS

We don't learn bias in lessons - we absorb it from playgrounds, media, family, workplaces, and the words around us. Much of it is set early, and the rest goes unquestioned. The Equal Lens exists to interrupt that. We design playful, purposeful experiences - games, scenarios, a site you can literally draw on - that make bias visible and invite reflection, rather than lecturing about fairness. Two moves sit at the heart of everything: unlearn inherited assumptions, and relearn with empathy. Working across schools, families, and communities, we help people treat fairness as active, ongoing, and theirs to shape. Bias is learned - so it can be unlearned.

**Let's build a fairer playground.**

support@theequallens.com · theequallens.com · @theequallensorg

# One source of truth.

Every brand decision ships as a named CSS token, defined once and flipped for the dark theme. Design and build reference the same names, so they can't drift. This is the full map.

| TOKEN | LIGHT (KIDS) | DARK (ADULT) | ROLE |
|---|---|---|---|
| --color-brand | #553286 | #C9B8E6 | Primary violet |
| --color-brandsoft | #7F65A4 | #B3A4D6 | Muted violet |
| --color-paper | #FBF9FF | #15101F | Page background |
| --color-surface | #FFFFFF | #221A30 | Cards / notes |
| --color-mist | #E7E0F1 | #3A2E4D | Lines / hover |
| --color-ink | #221436 | #F1ECFA | Text & outlines |
| --color-band | #553286 | #241B38 | Footer / CTA band |
| --dot | #ECE6F6 | #2A2140 | Dotted-paper texture |
| --color-insight | #2DD4BF | | Teal · Unlearn |
| --color-grow | #FF7A5C | | Coral · Relearn |
| --color-sun | #FFC94D | | Yellow · highlight / CTA |
| --color-sky | #4FB0E8 | | Blue · support |
| --font-display | Poppins | | Wordmark / UI |
| --font-body | Nunito Sans | | Body |
| --font-hand | Baloo 2 | | Headlines / mascots |

The full violet ramp (50-900) and these tokens live in src/app/globals.css. The dark values sit under [data-audience="adult"]; accents and fonts are shared by both themes.

## Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.

The Equal Lens · Brand & Product Guidelines · v2.0 · June 2026